

# VICTOR O. KOLAWOLE

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28/07/2026

Dear Hiring Manager,

## Cover Letter

As a finance and audit professional with experience across two major Nigerian banks, combined with hands-on UK experience in bookkeeping, VAT, and payroll, I am confident I can bring immediate value to your finance and assurance function. I am currently completing an MSc in Finance at Bangor University alongside my ACCA (Part Qualified) studies, and I am seeking a role where I can continue building my career in audit, financial reporting, and internal controls within the UK market.

In my roles at Providus Bank and United Bank for Africa, I conducted and contributed to over **441 risk-based audit engagements, 66 investigations, spot checks, and special reviews**, covering finance, treasury, compliance, trade finance, human resources, legal services, and operational functions. My responsibilities included planning audit fieldwork, performing control testing, evaluating financial and operational processes, documenting findings, and presenting practical recommendations to management. I also participated in follow-up reviews to verify that agreed corrective actions had been implemented effectively. This experience enabled me to identify control weaknesses, strengthen governance, and deliver evidence-based recommendations that enhanced operational efficiency and regulatory compliance.

Beyond routine audit assignments, I developed process improvements that delivered measurable operational benefits. At United Bank for Africa, I designed and automated a VBA-based reconciliation tool that reduced the processing time for reconciling over **10,000 transactions** from several hours of manual work to a significantly faster and more accurate process. The solution was subsequently adopted within the Internal Control unit to improve efficiency and consistency. Earlier in my career at New Hope Agriculture & Technology Limited, I successfully resolved a **three-year outstanding bank reconciliation issue**, significantly improving the accuracy and reliability of the company's financial records. I contributed to the successful completion of a **US\$2.1 million funding arrangement** by preparing financing schedules, reviewing supporting documentation, and coordinating the financial information required throughout the transaction. I also played a key role in the **implementation of a boiler gas installation project**, providing financial coordination and documentation for the transition to a more efficient energy system, helping improve operational efficiency and reduce energy costs.

Since relocating to the UK, I have strengthened this foundation through my role as a Trainee Bookkeeper at Aston Pearl Accountants, where I managed VAT submissions under multiple VAT schemes, ensured Making Tax Digital compliance using Sage 50, QuickBooks, and Xero, processed payroll including RTI submissions and pension contributions, and supported bookkeeping for multiple clients. Combined with my earlier experience in accounts payable, accounts receivable, bank reconciliations, and financial reporting, I offer a well-rounded technical background across both audit and accounting functions. I am also proficient in Microsoft Excel, including PivotTables, VLOOKUP/XLOOKUP, Power Query, and VBA automation, together with Power BI for reporting and financial data analysis.

Alongside my postgraduate studies, I have also undertaken operational roles within UK retail, warehouse, and manufacturing environments. Although outside my primary finance background, these positions have strengthened my adaptability, attention to detail, teamwork, and understanding of UK workplace practices. They have reinforced my ability to deliver high-quality work under pressure while maintaining accuracy and meeting demanding deadlines.

I am enthusiastic about the opportunity to contribute my audit expertise, accounting knowledge, analytical skills, and continuous improvement mindset to your organisation. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience and achievements align with your team's objectives.

I look forward to the opportunity to discuss my suitability further and would be pleased to provide any additional information or attend an interview at your convenience.

Yours sincerely,

Victor O. Kolawole